PIETRO ZECCA

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Data-driven international development professional with demonstrated expertise in statistical analysis, data visualization, and reproducible research using R programming. Experienced in analyzing complex datasets to derive actionable insights for policy and program evaluation. Skilled in data wrangling, web scraping, custom function development, and creating publication-quality visualizations. Combines strong quantitative skills with practical experience in project management and stakeholder coordination to drive evidence-based decision-making in international development contexts.

DATA ANALYSIS & PROGRAMMING SKILLS

Programming Languages: R (advanced), including tidyverse ecosystem (ggplot2, dplyr, tidyr, purrr).

Statistical Analysis: Regression modeling, hypothesis testing, descriptive statistics, data visualization.

Data Wrangling: Data cleaning, transformation, web scraping (rvest), API integration, large dataset manipulation.

Visualization: Advanced data visualization using ggplot2, creating publication-ready charts and graphics.

Literate Programming: Quarto, R Markdown for reproducible research and automated reporting.

Version Control: Git, GitHub for collaborative coding and project management.

Software: R, RStudio, Microsoft Office Suite (Excel advanced formulas and pivot tables), Canva.

Languages: Italian (native), English (fluent), Spanish (intermediate), German & French (beginner).

DATA ANALYSIS PROJECTS

U.S. Congressional Bill Sponsorship Analysis (Spring 2026)

• Scraped and analyzed legislative data from C-SPAN website using R (rvest package)
• Created custom functions to automate data extraction and analysis for 10 U.S. Senators
• Developed professional visualizations comparing bill sponsorship patterns by party affiliation
• Technologies: R, web scraping, custom functions, ggplot2, data transformation

Global Financial Inclusion Analysis (Spring 2026)

• Analyzed World Bank Global Findex Database (8,500+ observations across 150+ countries)
• Investigated mobile money adoption patterns and financial inclusion disparities using statistical methods
• Created publication-quality visualizations identifying outlier countries
• Generated reproducible research report using Quarto with embedded R code and analysis
• Technologies: R, Quarto, statistical analysis, data wrangling, advanced visualization

EDUCATION

- **Expected December 2026: American University, Washington D.C.**

Master of Arts in International Development – School of International Service. Recipient of the **SIS Dean's Graduate Assistantship Award** based on exceptional academic achievement and potential. **GPA: 3.96/4.** Graduate Certificate in Social Innovation for Global Impact.

Relevant Coursework: Innovation for Social Impact, International Affairs Stats & Methods, Economic Development, Project Design Monitoring & Evaluation, Data Analysis.

Data Analysis Coursework Highlights:

• Completed rigorous training in R programming, data wrangling, and statistical visualization
• Developed expertise in reproducible research using literate programming (Quarto/R Markdown)
• Created custom R functions for automated data analysis and iterative operations
• Demonstrated proficiency in web scraping, API integration, and working with messy real-world datasets

• Built portfolio of original research products featuring professional data visualizations and statistical analysis: https://github.com/pietro1361/data-analysis-portfolio

Practicum: Planning for Conflict & Climate Migrants (International Organization for Migration).

Graduate Assistant to Professor C. Austin Davis: Essentials of Economics and Data Analytics (Fall 2025), International Affairs Stats & Methods (Spring 2026).

- **2024: Bocconi University, Milan (Italy)**

MSc in Economics and Management of Government and International Organizations. **Final grade: 110/110. Dissertation:** "Cluster competitiveness & sustainable development: the Lombardy Energy Cleantech Cluster".

Relevant Coursework: Quantitative Methods for Social Sciences, Economics and Policy of Global Markets, Management of International Organizations and NGOs, Policy Analysis and Evaluation, Long-Term Investments and Public-Private Partnerships, Social Innovation.

Activities & societies: European Generation, Bocconi Students International Law Society.

Selected as graduate exchange student based on academic achievement at the **University of Southern California** (Sol Price School of Public Policy, January – May 2023).

- **2021: Bocconi University, Milan (Italy)**

BSc in International Economics and Management. **Final grade: 101/110. Dissertation:** "Boston's plan towards the smart city: a case study".

Relevant Coursework: Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Statistics, Mathematics (General & Applied), Computer Science, Corporate Finance, Financial Markets and Institutions, European Economic Policy, International Economics, Business Strategy.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- **May – July 2025: Research Assistant, Samuel Hall (Nairobi, Kenya)**

Conducted desk research and literature review, contributing to the inception and final evaluation reports by the MEAL team. Supported data collection and analysis by reviewing and coding Key Informant Interviews against evaluation criteria, and assisted in conducting interviews. Prepared project-related outputs, including presentations, annexes, and contextual analyses, ensuring alignment with evaluation frameworks and donor requirements.

- **January – October 2024: Business Management Intern, Piana Nonwovens (Cartersville, GA)**

Conducted comprehensive market research and analysis to inform executive decision-making. Developed strategic documents to support business operations, including workflow optimization, logistics, inventory management, supplier evaluation. Collaborated with cross-functional teams to optimize operational efficiency.

- **September – December 2023: Project Management Intern, A2A (Milan, Italy)**

Assisted in digital HR transformation projects, enhancing organizational integration. Coordinated among project stakeholders to ensure alignment and goal achievement. Applied project management methodologies to drive successful project outcomes.

- **May – August 2023: Intern, Embassy of Italy in the United States (Washington D.C.)**

Intern in the Office for Economic, Trade and Scientific Affairs. Carried out research and analysis on US economic and trade policies, data processing activities and engaged in the organization of events. Reported on US Congress hearings and advanced drafting skills by writing briefs.

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- Introduction to Behavioral Science in Public Policy, The World Bank (March 2025)
- Reproducible Research Fundamentals, The World Bank (April 2025)
- Manage Successful Field Research, The World Bank (December 2025)
- Social and Behavioral Responsible Conduct of Research, CITI Program (January 2026)